

Day 14 Activity: Get Git working (weekend setup)

Friday, June 5, 2026 · due 11:59 p.m. Tuesday, June 9

Your Name Here

By **Tuesday June 9** your project team needs a shared GitHub repo that **every member can push to**.

Work through the steps in order. Each links to the matching chapter of [Happy Git with R](#) (Jenny Bryan); read its instructions there and use this page as the checklist. Part 5 covers the common ones, and feel free to come to office hours if you get stuck.

Note

We use **RStudio's built-in Git integration** with **HTTPS + a personal access token (PAT)**. That matches *DC* Ch. 9 and Happy Git, and keeps everything inside RStudio.

Part 1 — Accounts and installs (solo)

- ☐ **Register a GitHub account** (if you don't already have one): happygitwithr.com/github-acct. Pick a username that's professional-ish; you may reuse it.
- ☐ **R and RStudio up to date**: [install-r-studio](#). You set these up in week 1; just confirm they're current.
- ☐ **Install Git**: [install-git](#). (Windows: Git for Windows. macOS: easiest is to run `git --version` in the Terminal and accept the install prompt.)
- ☐ **Introduce yourself to Git**: [hello-git](#). Set your name and the email tied to your GitHub account. This is easiest from the R console:

```
# install.packages("usethis") # once, if you don't have it
library(usethis)
use_git_config(
  user.name = "Your Name",      # your name, doesn't have to be your username
  user.email = "you@example.com" # the SAME email as your GitHub account
)
```

Part 2 — Connect RStudio, Git, and GitHub (solo)

- ☐ Create a personal access token (PAT): <https-pat>. From the R console:

```
# install.packages(c("usethis", "gitcreds")) # run this exactly once
usethis::create_github_token() # opens GitHub; generate the token, COPY it
gitcreds::gitcreds_set()      # paste the token when prompted
```

Warning

Treat the token like a password. You should copy it the moment you create it, because GitHub won't show it again. If you happen to lose it, just make a new one.

- ☐ Confirm the connection works: <push-pull-github>.
- ☐ Confirm RStudio sees Git: <rstudio-git-github> and <rstudio-see-git>. Check *Tools > Global Options > Git/SVN* shows a Git executable.

Part 3 — Test repo (solo)

Follow <new-github-first>:

- ☐ On **GitHub**, create a new repository (check “Add a README”).
- ☐ Copy its URL (the green **Code** button, then HTTPS).
- ☐ In **RStudio**: *File > New Project > Version Control > Git*, paste the URL, create.
- ☐ Open README.md, add a line like “Test repo for STAT 184”, and **save**.
- ☐ In the **Git** tab (top-right pane): tick the box to **stage** README.md, click **Commit**, write a message, then **Push** (up arrow).

- ☐ Refresh the repo page on GitHub. **Your line is there.**

If your change shows up on GitHub, your setup is done. The rest of the term is just repeating this loop.

Part 4 — The team repo (together, asynchronously over the weekend)

Coordinate with your team over the weekend.

One person (the repo owner):

- ☐ Create the team repo on GitHub (with a README). Name it something like `stat184-project-teamNN`.
- ☐ *Settings > Collaborators*, then add each teammate by GitHub username.

Everyone else:

- ☐ Accept the email/GitHub invitation.
- ☐ Clone the repo into RStudio (*New Project > Version Control > Git*, paste the URL).

Each member, including the owner:

- ☐ **Pull** first (down arrow) to get everyone's latest.
- ☐ Add your name on its own line in the README, save.
- ☐ Stage, Commit (message like "Add Charles to README"), then **Push**.
- ☐ **Verify:** on GitHub, the README lists **every** member's name, and the repo's commit history shows **at least one commit per person**.

Tip

If two of you edit the README at the same time, you may hit a **merge conflict**, that's fine, it's good practice. See Part 5, and remember the rule: **pull before you push**.

Part 5 — When it goes wrong (troubleshooting)

You will hit at least one of these. None of them mean you broke anything.

Table 1: Common setup snags.

Symptom	What's happening	What to do
Push rejected	A teammate pushed since your last pull	Pull , then push again
Merge conflict	Two people changed the same lines	Open the file, keep the right lines, remove the <<<</====/>>>> markers, commit
Changes don't appear in Git tab	Wrong RStudio Project is open	Switch to the Project tied to that repo
"File too large" (>50 MB)	A big data file got staged	Don't commit it; add it to <code>.gitignore</code>
Auth fails on push	PAT missing/expired	Redo <code>gitcreds::gitcreds_set()</code> (Part 2)

Resources:

- Happy Git's [troubleshooting](#) chapter.
- The "[Burn it all down](#)" move: delete the broken local folder and **re-clone** a fresh copy from GitHub.

Feel free to come to office hours on Monday if you get stuck.

Turn in

Submit on Canvas:

1. The **URL of your team repo**.
2. Confirmation that **all members have pushed** (the easiest proof is a screenshot of the repo's commit history or contributors list).

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